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ARTICLE

Israel Is Approaching A Prophetic Milestone Few Generations Thought Possible



BY PNW STAFF SEPTEMBER 14, 2026

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For nearly 2,000 years, the Jewish people lived primarily outside the land of Israel. They survived expulsions, persecution, pogroms and eventually the Holocaust, scattered across virtually every corner of the world.

Now that extraordinary pattern of history is moving rapidly in the opposite direction.

New figures released by Israel's Central Bureau of Statistics estimate the worldwide Jewish population at approximately 15.9 million. About 46 percent of them now live in Israel.

And according to one of the world's leading Jewish demographers, Israel could cross an astonishing threshold within the next decade: for the first time in the modern era, a majority of the world's Jews could be living in the land of Israel.

Professor Sergio DellaPergola has projected that the symbolic 50 percent threshold could be crossed as early as 2035 if current demographic trends continue.

For students of Bible prophecy, this is far more interesting than another population statistic.

Something is happening to the Jewish people that the prophets described thousands of years ago.



From 5 Percent To Nearly Half

Consider how dramatically the picture has changed.

At the end of World War II, only about 5 percent of the world's Jewish population lived in Israel. By 2023, that number had climbed to approximately 45

percent.

Israel's Jewish population grew from roughly half a million in 1945 to more than seven million, while the Jewish population outside Israel declined over that same broad period.

DellaPergola has described Israel as essentially the major growing component of world Jewry. Higher fertility, immigration and demographic decline or stagnation in many Diaspora communities continue pushing the center of Jewish life toward Israel.

If those trends continue, sometime around the middle of the next decade the scales could finally tip.

After centuries in which the overwhelming majority of Jews lived among the nations, the majority could once again be living in their ancestral homeland.

The prophets repeatedly said such a gathering would happen.

"I Will Gather You"

Ezekiel recorded God's declaration to Israel:

"I will take you from among the heathen, and gather you out of all countries, and will bring you into your own land." — Ezekiel 36:24

Jeremiah described the same remarkable future:

"He that scattered Israel will gather him, and keep him, as a shepherd doth his flock." — Jeremiah 31:10

Isaiah spoke of the Lord gathering "the dispersed of Judah from the four corners of the earth." Ezekiel's famous vision of the dry bones portrayed Israel being restored from what appeared to be national death.

For most of Christian history, these passages presented an extraordinary question.



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Where was Israel?

There was no Jewish state. Jerusalem was controlled by successive foreign powers. Jews were scattered throughout Europe, North Africa, the Middle East and eventually the Americas.

Anyone insisting that the prophets meant what they said had to believe that history could somehow reverse itself.

Then came 1948.

Israel returned to the map.

And the gathering continued.

The Prophetic Story Didn't End In 1948

Christians sometimes speak about the rebirth of Israel as though the prophetic event happened on May 14, 1948, and everything afterward has simply been political history.

But the biblical picture of restoration involves more than establishing a government. It repeatedly involves the Jewish people themselves returning to the

land.

That process has continued for nearly eight decades.

Jews arrived from Europe after the Holocaust. Hundreds of thousands came from Middle Eastern and North African countries. Later came enormous waves from the former Soviet Union. Ethiopian Jews were brought home in dramatic airlifts. Jews have continued making aliyah from France, Britain, the United States, Ukraine, Russia and elsewhere.

And the gathering is not merely something found in Israel's history books. More than 20,000 new olim from over 100 countries are expected to celebrate their first Rosh Hashanah as Israeli citizens this year. Russia, France and the United States lead the list, but newcomers are arriving from across North America, Europe, South America and Australia.

Even more striking is when they are coming. Israel has endured the October 7 massacre, years of war, missile attacks and direct conflict with Iran. War normally sends people fleeing in the opposite direction. Yet thousands of Jews are still packing their belongings and moving toward Israel.

Many are young. Thirty-five percent of this year's new immigrants are between 18 and 35. One 19-year-old immigrant from New York described how October 7 changed him spiritually: he became more religious and came to see Zionism and faith as inseparable. He moved to Israel and now hopes to serve meaningfully in the IDF.

Other new immigrants speak about deeper meaning, stronger Jewish community and wanting their children to experience a sense of belonging in the land of Israel. For some, October 7 strengthened that sense of solidarity and accelerated a decision already taking shape.

The prophets spoke repeatedly of Jews returning from many countries. What previous generations could only imagine, today's Israelis can watch arriving through Ben Gurion Airport.

The result is now visible in the numbers.

The nation that contained only a tiny fraction of world Jewry several generations ago is approaching the point where it could contain most of them.

There is no biblical verse declaring that when Israel reaches 50 percent of the world's Jewish population a prophetic clock strikes midnight. We should not invent prophetic markers Scripture does not give us.

But we should not ignore the direction of history Scripture does give us.

The Jewish people are being concentrated once again in the land of Israel.

Not Just A Physical Return

There is another development unfolding inside Israel that deserves attention. The gathering is geographical, but among many Israelis something spiritual also appears to be stirring.

Since the October 7 attacks and the wars that followed, surveys have documented increased interest in faith and Jewish tradition, particularly among younger Israelis. Prayer, reading the Tanakh and Psalms, wearing tefillin and other expressions of Jewish identity became increasingly visible during the war, including among soldiers.

One major survey found 35 percent of young Jewish Israelis saying their belief in God had increased during the war. Thirty-eight percent said they were praying more, while 26 percent reported reading the Bible or Psalms more frequently. Another survey found 76 percent of Israelis ages 18–34 saying God was important in their lives. Remarkably, 59 percent of that age group said they believed in the coming of the Messiah.

This should not be confused with a nationwide religious revival. Secular Israelis remain a major part of Israeli society, and surveys show the movement toward religion has been much stronger among Israelis who already possessed some connection to Jewish tradition.

But something has clearly been shaken loose.

The generation fighting Israel's wars is asking questions about God, Jewish identity, the land and Israel's purpose in history.

And then there is the Temple.

For generations, rebuilding the Jewish Temple could easily be dismissed as the obsession of a tiny religious fringe. Today organizations such as the Temple Institute openly prepare vessels and other items associated with future Temple worship, while Jewish visits and prayer on the Temple Mount have become increasingly prominent political issues.

The subject has even moved into mainstream Israeli politics. Government ministers have ascended the Temple Mount, Jewish prayer there has become increasingly public, and politicians openly sympathetic to establishing greater Jewish sovereignty over Judaism's holiest site now occupy positions of genuine influence.

For students of prophecy, that development is impossible to ignore.

Daniel 9 speaks of sacrifice being stopped. Jesus points His disciples back to Daniel's "abomination of desolation" while describing future events. Paul describes a future "man of sin" sitting in the temple of God. Revelation 11 even speaks of measuring the Temple of God and its altar.

Those passages have led generations of prophecy scholars to conclude that some form of Jewish Temple and sacrificial worship will exist during the events surrounding the end of the age.

We are not there today.

But the conversation itself has changed dramatically.

The same land that once had almost no Jews, no Jewish state, no Jewish army and no Jewish sovereignty over Jerusalem now contains more than seven million Jews—and within it is a growing movement openly talking about the Temple again.

That is an extraordinary reversal of history.

The End-Times Map Is Taking Shape

This becomes even more significant when we look beyond the restoration prophecies.

Many passages concerning the last days assume something remarkable: Israel exists, Jews inhabit the land, and Jerusalem occupies the center of world attention.

Zechariah describes Jerusalem becoming "a burdensome stone for all people" and eventually portrays the nations gathering against Jerusalem.

Daniel's prophetic visions repeatedly return attention to Israel and Jerusalem.

Jesus warned about future events taking place in Judea and told those living there to flee when they saw the signs He described.

Revelation 11 places Jerusalem at the center of extraordinary events during the Tribulation.

None of this looked remotely plausible for most of the last 2,000 years.

Imagine reading those passages in 1750.

There was no State of Israel. There was no Israeli government. There was no Jewish army. Most Jews lived hundreds or thousands of miles from Jerusalem.

Yet the prophetic Scriptures continued talking about Israel as though the nation would someday be there.

Today it is.

And now the Jewish people themselves are increasingly there as well.

History Is Moving Toward Jerusalem

Perhaps one of the most remarkable aspects of Bible prophecy is that the world increasingly resembles the geopolitical landscape Scripture said would exist before the culmination of history.

Israel has returned.

Jerusalem is again the capital and heartbeat of the Jewish nation.

The Jewish population has been gathering from the nations.

Israel is surrounded by enemies while simultaneously becoming one of the most scrutinized countries on earth.

And now another milestone appears on the horizon.

Within roughly a decade, most Jews on planet Earth may be living in Israel.

Previous generations of Christians read Isaiah, Jeremiah, Ezekiel, Zechariah and Revelation and believed these things by faith. They could see little evidence around them suggesting how literally such circumstances might someday emerge.

We have the opposite problem.

We can become so accustomed to Israel being on the evening news that we forget how extraordinary its very existence is.

The question isn't whether crossing 50 percent fulfills a particular prophecy.

The more important question is how many prophetic pieces must fall into place before we recognize the larger picture.

The God who said He would scatter Israel also said He would gather Israel.

And before our eyes, the scattered people are coming home.

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